vehicles and we proceeded ahead. We reached near the site of the encounter within an hour, dismounted from the vehicles and proceeded cautiously till we closed in. Up to this moment we had no idea whatsoever as to who was fighting and with whom. Soon Captain S.S. Anjaria of 2/11 GR crept up to me and started to brief me about the situation. Before he could begin, I told him that I had with me about fifty soldiers who could be employed to beef up his force. So it was decided that the motley group of men doing the map-reading test could be used in squads of eight men to form an outer ring to isolate the area and prevent the terrorists from escaping, whereas the QRT and my protection party would engage the terrorists hiding in the folds of the sloping ground. This timely arrival of additional troops gave the hard-pressed men of 2/11 GR a shot in the arm.

Thereafter Anjaria proceeded to brief me, and I was truly impressed with the actions of this brave officer and his outnumbered gallant Gurkhas. Despite the odds, they had hemmed in about twenty-odd heavily armed terrorists coming down the hill from the direction of the LoC. By this engagement, they had prevented the infiltrators from entering a nearby village. Once there, the terrorists could have easily escaped by merging with the locals and concealing their weapons and equipment (see Sketch 12.1).

In this skirmish, the young captain and his men had knocked down eight to ten terrorists, and sporadic yet intense exchange of fire was continuing. We had no casualty from our side thus far, and we could count at least ten dead terrorists lying around in the broken ground ahead of us. It was around 11 a.m. and I was confident that in a couple of hours we would be able to take care of all of them. At that moment, I felt a sudden piercing pain. The realization that I had been shot struck me when I felt some warm fluid flowing down my left leg. It was blood oozing out from both wounds.

I slumped to the ground, and was assisted by VK and taken to a somewhat secure place nearby, away from direct fire of the terrorists. Someone got hold of a field dressing and tied a bandage